Chronology of Two Paths: the Anatomy of a Choice

* Presenting Choice *

Filtered Through the Heart (Lk 6:45)

WORSHIP

Self-Centered

Feeling Oriented (James 1:14; 4:1)

Based on Self-Love (Rooted in Pride)

What I Want

- Pleasure/Comfort
- Respect/Acknowledgment
- Control/Power/Acceptance
- Safety/Peace/Security

What I Don't Want

- Conflict
- Anxiety/Fear
- Pain
- Discomfort

Decision: Sin

Short-Term Evaluation: Easy

Temporary Pleasure (1 Jn 2:16; Heb 11:25)

Evaluation: Sin is Deceitful (Heb 3:13; Isa 55:1-2)

Long-Term Results: Hard (Prov 13:15; Ps 32:10)

Sadness	Guilt
Depression	Fear
Anger	Anxiety
Strife	Addiction
Lack of Fulfillment	Death
No Contentment	Frustration
Bitterness	Punishment
Jealousy	Hate

God-Centered

Principle Oriented (1 Cor 10:31; 2 Cor 5:9)

Based on *Agape* Love (Rooted in Humility)

What God Wants

- Love to God
- Love to Neighbor
- Fruit of Spirit
- Self-Denial

What God Does Not Want

- Pride/Selfishness
- Idolatry
- Works of Flesh/Injustice
- Tearing Down Others

Decision: Righteousness

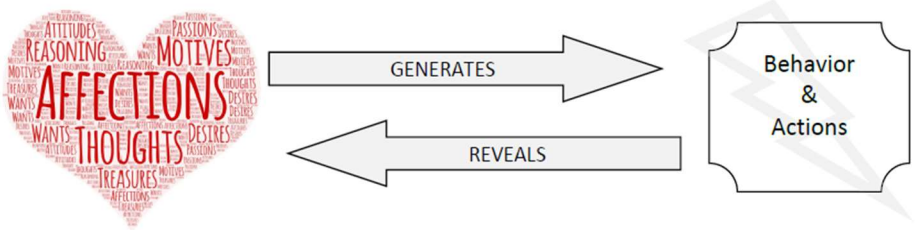
Short-Term Evaluation: Hard

Deny Yourself (Matt 16:24; 2 Cor 5:15)

Evaluation: Obedience Leads to Abundant Life (Jn 10:10)

Long-Term Results: Easier

Joy	Forgiveness
Clear Conscience	Genuine Relationships
Happiness	Deliverance
Purpose	Fulfillment
Peace	Hope
Contentment	Strength
Wisdom	Comfort
Humility	Boldness



Journal Questions

* Be sure to answer *every* detail of *every* question. Also, you are to **focus solely on *your* sin**, not the sin of another *

"Search me, O God, and know my heart! Try me and know my thoughts! And see if there be any grievous way in me, and lead me in the way everlasting" (Psalm 139:23–24)

Name: _____ Date/Time of the event: _____

1. What happened (Situation) and where?

2. What led up to the event *and* what decisions did you make (or not make) before choosing to act?
   1.
   2.
   3.

3. I DO what I DO (Actions), because I THINK what I THINK (Attitudes), because I WANT what I WANT (Treasures).
   a. What was I **feeling** at the time?

   b. My response or **action**:

   c. What was I **thinking** at the time?

   d. What did I **want** as the outcome?

4. Using the Two-Paths Chart, s*pecifically* identify your heart idols (pleasure, peace, control, respect, etc.)

I **wanted**: Pleasure Comfort Respect Acknowledgment Control Power Acceptance Safety Peace Security

I did **NOT want**: Conflict Anxiety Fear Pain Discomfort

5. Circle the aspects of the Fruit of the Spirit below that this event show you need to grow in?

Love Joy Peace Patience Kindness Goodness Faithfulness Gentleness Self-Control

7. How did your action make the other(s) feel?

8. A Biblical Response (Next Time):
   a. I **want** to glorify God by:

   b. What would have been God-honoring **thoughts**?

   c. What could I have **done** differently?

   d. How will this likely make me **feel** (see 2 paths chart)?

9. Practicing **change** and **true repentance**!
   a. Write out a complete Bible verse (with citation) and memorize it this week.

   b. Write a **change statement** and meditate on it this week 3x per day.
   The next time I...

   c. **Commit to pray daily** about this issue for 1 week.
   d. Confess this sin to another brother/sister and **ask for accountability and prayer** if needed.

11. Did you repent *and* make things right before God __ and others __ ? Confess to the other person. Use the words below as a reminder and guide.

When I **[3b]**, I was really wanting **[4]**. I recognize that my actions hurt you and you felt **[7]**. Next time this happens, I want to respond by **[8c]**. To help me grow and change in this area I am going to **[9a, 9b, 9c, and 9d]**. Will you forgive me?